

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

THURSDAY, JULY 30, 2026

Convention center chief pulls out of deal

Barros faced pressure after landing \$2b contract to build Springfield courthouse

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

Under immense pressure and a lawsuit challenging the deal, the head of the Massachusetts convention center authority said Wednesday that he is “divesting” from a controversial \$2 billion contract

with the state government to build a new courthouse in downtown Springfield.

Through his attorney, interim authority director John Barros said he is also divesting from the company involved in the winning bid, CoJo Real Estate, which he owned

with Conan Harris, the husband of US Representative Ayanna Pressley. CoJo was part of the team dubbed Liberty Junction that won the bid to build the project.

“Notwithstanding the fact that John did everything right and complied fully with the law, he has determined that the significant public benefits that will come from the Liberty Junction Team’s project — a beautiful, safe new courthouse and

an engine for economic development in downtown Springfield — outweigh his personal interests,” his lawyer, Gary Ronan, said in a statement.

After years of complaints that the outdated courthouse in Springfield, built in 1971, was mold-infested and making people sick, the state solicited proposals for a new building in 2025.

COURTHOUSE, Page A7

Clancy jury hears horror of 911 call

Ex-husband allowed to leave before tape played

By Shelley Murphy, Sean Cotter, and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — Patrick Clancy was led out of the courtroom midway through his testimony Wednesday, sparing him the trauma of hearing the 911 recording of his gut-wrenching screams as he told police his wife had killed their three children while he was picking up dinner.

But the jury in the murder trial of his-then wife, Lindsay, heard the entire call, from the moment he found her injured on the lawn of their Duxbury home on Jan. 24, 2023, after jumping out a second-story window, to the discovery of the bodies of his children in the basement.

He screamed, “She killed the kids!”

During the recording, several members of the jury fought back tears and others appeared shaken. The recording was so graphic that Plymouth Superior Judge William F. Sullivan previously took the extraordinary step of prohibiting its release to the public, allowing only those present in the courtroom to hear it.

Lindsay Clancy, paralyzed by her unsuccessful suicide attempt, sobbed uncontrollably in her wheelchair as jurors were led out of the courtroom for a break after the playing of the 911 call. Her lawyer, Kevin Reddington, placed his hand on her

CLANCY, Page A6



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

The makeovers of their lives

With a new look, women feel the support they need after incarceration



By Jessica Rinaldi and Audrey Tomlin
GLOBE STAFF AND GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

SOMERVILLE — Women rebuilding their lives, some after incarceration, sat in brown leather salon chairs, wearing shirts that read “Seen. Valued. Worthy,” as stylists dressed in all black arranged their hair and painted their makeup at a salon on Monday before a professional photo shoot.

The women were styled and photographed as part of an event hosted by New Beginnings Reentry Services, a nonprofit aimed at breaking the cycle of recidivism.

As stylists carefully twisted curling irons, the salon

SPA, Page A10

Above, Rosie Calle (center) was overcome after her makeover. She was comforted by Angel Lyte and Sharita Payton. At left, Kanaya Ryland thanked the stylists.



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Patrick Clancy testified that at one point, his then-wife spoke about harming the children.

‘No sense of urgency’ with state’s report on guardians

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

Two years ago, the Legislature gave state health officials a pointed directive: Tell us how to create a system of professional legal guardians to help the thousands of people who cannot make medical decisions for themselves, some of whom languish in hospitals unnecessarily.

But the Massachusetts Department of Public Health has yet to produce that report, and as of this week it is a year overdue.

“It’s like the bombs are going off around us,” said Dr. Eric Dickson, chief executive of UMass Memorial Health. “For whatever reason, there’s no sense of urgency.”

Currently in Massachusetts, the position of legal guardian is effectively a volunteer job, yet they play a crucial role: not only do they aid people in need, they also help rationalize the health care system.

Those hospital patients who can’t represent themselves but are medically ready to be discharged to a rehabilitation center, long-term-care facility, or a skilled nursing home need a guardian to sign off. Otherwise, they occupy hospital beds intended for more acute patients, contributing to overcrowding and lengthy wait times, health care providers said.

DPH said in a statement that its recommendations were delayed by additional data gathering and analysis and that its report would be out “shortly.”

“DPH is committed to supporting patients who cannot represent themselves,” said Ann Scales, the agency spokesperson. “This includes addressing the shortage of medical guardians as well as work to increase the number of people who have health care proxies, in order to reduce the need for guardianship.”

GUARDIANS, Page A6

On the mend, and grateful to be back

CHRISTOPHER L. GASPER

The sportsosphere loves a comeback story. I just never thought I would be writing about my own.

Returning to work after a more than six-week absence because of June 2 surgery for prostate cancer has been gratifying, rewarding, humbling, and eye-opening. It feels familiar and foreign at the same time, mirroring my body. I’m still me, but different — changed, chastened, more sanguine.

I find myself brimming with empathy for athletes who suffer serious injuries and get taken away from their livelihoods such as Celtics star Jayson Tatum, who sat out for 298 days while rehabbing a torn Achilles. Your vo-

cation and identity are snatched from you. The realization sets in that the pursuit you made the center of your world just goes on without you. You wonder when, and if, you’ll return to who you were.

Your world gets small. Simple functions you once took for granted — in my case, bladder control, sitting upright, traversing up and down stairs — become daily tests of willpower and pain tolerance, then celebrated milestones.

I received an outpouring of support from family, friends, colleagues, former athletes, fans, and fellow prostate cancer patients, including dozens of Globe readers. Yet, there were times I felt completely isolated,

GASPER, Page C2

MAKING A SPLASH

Wednesday was a rainy one across most of New England, with areas to the west getting several inches from slow-moving storms. The Boston area wasn’t hit quite as hard but it was still a day for the raincoats. **B1, B4.**



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts lawmakers struck a deal on a bill that would protect immigrants from civil arrests in court-houses and schools. **B1.**

The Citgo sign will feature all new parts and pieces when it returns to illuminate the skyline this fall. **D1.**

The Federal Reserve kept interest rates unchanged despite growing pressure to more directly tackle inflation. **D1.**

Dr. Anthony Fauci repeatedly declined to answer Republicans’ questions in a grilling on the COVID-19 pandemic. **A2.**

Running dry
Thursday: A shower or two. High 66-71. Low 62-67.
Friday: Maybe some sun. High 71-76. Low 64-69.
Weather and Comics, D5-6.

VOL. 310, NO. 30

*

Suggested retail price
\$4.00

